FREE CHECKLIST · BEFORE YOU LAUNCH

The Pre-Launch Checklist

10 things to get right before you launch a business, and the expensive mistake each one saves you from. From Business Plans Plus · buildwithbpp.com

Most new businesses don't fail because the idea was bad. They fail because the launch skipped steps that were boring, cheap, and completely fixable. This is the list we wish every founder worked through before spending a dollar on anything else.

1 Write the one-page plan first

Not 40 pages. One page: who you serve, what you sell, what it costs, what you charge, how people find you, what you need monthly to survive. If it doesn't work on one page, more pages won't save it.

Skip this mistake: building the product, logo, and website before you can explain the business in two sentences.

2 Make it legal

Register the entity (an LLC for most), get your EIN, and check what licenses your county and state actually require.

Skip this mistake: operating "for now" as a handshake business. One incident without an entity between you and the world can cost you personally.

3 Separate the money on day one

Business bank account, business card, every business dollar through that account. Then 30 minutes a month of simple, categorized bookkeeping.

Skip this mistake: mixing personal and business money. Untangling a year of it at tax time costs more than the accountant you were avoiding.

4 Price from your costs, not your competitors

Know what delivery actually costs you (labor, materials, overhead), then price for a real margin. Competitors' prices tell you the range, not whether you survive in it.

Skip this mistake: copying the cheapest competitor. They might be losing money too.

5 Define one clear offer

One service, clearly described, for one kind of customer, at one price. Add more later. Confused prospects don't buy.

Skip this mistake: "we do everything" positioning. It reads as "we specialize in nothing."

6 Claim your name everywhere at once

Business name, domain, professional email on your own domain, social handles. One sitting, before you print anything.

Skip this mistake: business cards printed before the domain search. Renaming after launch costs every dollar twice.

7 Build a front door, not a mansion

One clean page: what you do, proof you're real, an obvious next step (call, book, request a quote). Plus a claimed Google Business Profile. That's launch-ready.

Skip this mistake: three months and $5K on a 12-page website before your first customer. The single page wins work while the mansion is under construction.

8 Get the paperwork that protects you

A simple service agreement or terms template, and the insurance your industry expects. Boring until the day it's the most important document you own.

Skip this mistake: working from texts and verbal agreements. "We agreed on something different" is the most expensive sentence in small business.

9 Know where customer #1 comes from

Pick one channel you'll work consistently: referrals from your old industry, one local network, one platform. Write the plan for the first ten customers by name or by source.

Skip this mistake: launching and waiting. "Open" is not a marketing strategy, and neither is one post announcing it.

10 Decide how you'll deliver before you sell

Sketch the steps from "customer says yes" to "work delivered and paid": how they book, what happens first, who does what, when payment lands. Even solo, write it down.

Skip this mistake: winning your first customers and improvising the delivery. First impressions become referrals, or they don't.

How ready are you, really?

Take the free 2-minute **Foundation Readiness Score** for a gap-by-gap breakdown across the 5 foundations: legal and money, brand and presence, offer and pricing, first-clients engine, and simple operations.

Want the whole foundation built with you in about 30 days? That's our Launch Pad engagement: legal setup, brand, offer, pricing, and your first lead engine, done properly, once. Start with a free 30-minute call at **buildwithbpp.com/booking**.

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